

STAGE ELEVEN • TOOLS & TECHNOLOGY

FIRSTS

ICEBREAKERS / OPENERS

Short, stage-themed warm-ups tied to what each session actually covers

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Icebreakers / Openers

Stage Eleven • Tools & Technology

PURPOSE

Stage Eleven runs across three sessions — Core Productivity & Office Tools, Personal Systems & Technical Foundations, and Advanced Tools, Automation & Optimization — each gets one icebreaker below, built directly from that session's actual content.

Each one uses a real device or real tool the participant already has open, so the warm-up itself is a small piece of genuine hands-on practice, not just a conversation starter. This also surfaces, in the group's own discoveries and admissions, the exact gap or misconception the session's formal FIRSTS are about to address.

Each includes the instructions to read to the group, a time estimate, and a short note on why it's specifically the right opener for what comes next.

Three Openers, One Per Session

SESSION 1

The Feature I Never Knew Existed

TIME: 8 min

1. Ask each participant to open a tool they use constantly (email, a document editor, their phone) and spend 60 seconds looking for one feature or menu option they've genuinely never used.
2. In pairs, share what you found. Did either of you find something the other didn't know existed either?
3. Quick full-group tally: how many people found something genuinely new in a tool they use every single day?

WHY THIS WORKS

This makes visceral, before any formal teaching, the exact gap FIRST O1 (Tool Ecosystem Awareness) is built on — that even familiar tools have unexplored depth, let alone entire categories of tools people have never encountered.

SESSION 2

The System That Lives in Your Head

TIME: 8 min

1. Ask the group: “where does your task list actually live right now — an app, paper, or just your memory?” Quick show of hands for each.
2. For anyone who said “my memory,” ask: “has anything ever fallen through the cracks because of that?”
3. Facilitator doesn't lecture yet — just names that this session is about closing exactly that gap.

WHY THIS WORKS

This surfaces, in the group's own admissions, the unreliability problem that FIRSTS O11 and O12 are explicitly built to solve, making the case for full system adoption before the facilitator has to make it.

SESSION 3

Guess the Automation

TIME: 8 min

1. Facilitator describes 3 real, simple automations (e.g., “every email from my bank gets automatically labeled and filed”) without naming the tool used.
2. Groups guess: is this something requiring real coding skill, or something achievable with a no-code tool?
3. Reveal that all three are achievable without code, using simple, freely available automation tools.

WHY THIS WORKS

This directly undercuts the most common misconception in FIRST O22 — that automation only applies to obviously technical tasks — by showing genuinely simple examples before participants are asked to identify their own.